Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Tuesday, May 19, 2020 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

Mayor Collier gave a short introduction regarding the electronic Council meeting format and noted that the meeting was being livestreamed on the Town's website.

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the meeting of Council held on April 20, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. No questions were received.

5. Delegation and Petitions/Public Hearings

5.1 Official Plan Amendment Application OPA19-A1 Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z1/19 Jean Al Gardens Plaza 593 Taunton Road East

Eric Simpson, Planner, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and the recommendations contained therein. E. Simpson discussed the subject lands, purpose of the report, the development proposal, proposed Official Plan Amendment and Zoning By-law Amendment, proposed townhouse elevations, purchase and sale of Town-owned lands, planning policies, supporting materials, summary of public concerns, and recommendations.

Council Members asked questions regarding density, traffic movement, snow removal and storage, size of units, emergency access, and landscape planning. Members of the Committee expressed concerns with the reduced parking rate and private waste collection.

E. Simpson and Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members. E. Simpson provided clarification on details of the Transportation Impact Study. G. Romanowski indicated that details for several items acknowledged by Council will be further identified through the site plan review process.

Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services / Deputy Clerk, provided details of the three public participation channels made available to those wanting to provide comment on the application: via written submission, oral submission by dedicated phone line, or registration with the Clerk's office to participate in the electronic meeting. He noted that all written submissions received were included within the staff report; no other comments or requests to participate were received.

Martin Quarcoopome, Weston Consulting, responded to questions from Council Members and provided clarification on unit square footage, waste collection, target demographics, proposed transportation demand management incentives, and snow removal. G. Romanowski and M. Quarcoopome noted that further details will be included through the site plan review process.

Council Members requested the site plan application for the subject lands be brought forward at a future meeting of the Community Affairs and Planning Committee for consideration and approval.

With the consent of Members, the staff report included as Item 7.1 was brought forward in the order of business.

7.1 **Official Plan Amendment Application OPA19-A1**
Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z1/19
Jean Al Gardens Plaza
593 Taunton Road East

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That Official Plan Amendment OPA19-A1, submitted by Jean Al Gardens Plaza, as provided within Attachment 1 to this report, be approved; and

2. That Zoning By-law Amendment Z1/19, submitted by Jean Al Gardens Plaza, as provided within Attachment 2 to this report, be approved.

CARRIED

5.2 **Traffic Calming Warrant Update**

John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, delivered a presentation regarding the Town's traffic calming initiatives and warrant system. J. Grieve discussed what traffic calming is, the history of traffic calming in Ajax, proposed evaluation process, Ravenscroft Road Pilot Project, new traffic calming bollards, traffic calming projects, and project timelines.

Council Members asked questions regarding timelines and delays for future projects, priority projects for completion, on-street parking impact of traffic bollards, transparency of warrant scoring, future open houses, and completion of the Ravenscroft Road traffic calming project.

J. Grieve responded to questions from Council and discussed project delays due to COVID-19, scoring of warrants, and details on forthcoming public open houses and projects. He indicated that a list of projects could be shared on the Town's website following Council's approval of the new traffic warrant this fall.

G. Romanowski indicated that in coordination with Operations and Environmental Services, speed boards will be deployed and appropriate line painting will be completed on Ravenscroft Road.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 2, 3, and 4 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the balance of the report dated May 19, 2020 containing Items of Correspondence be adopted.

CARRIED

Council Members discussed Correspondence Item 2, "Town of Ajax Councillors' Office: Poverty Reduction Strategy Ontario", and shared information on the Ajax Homelessness Task Force and a housing-first strategy to homelessness.

Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 2 of the Correspondence Report "Town of Ajax Councillors' Office: Poverty Reduction Strategy Ontario" be received for information.

CARRIED

Council Members discussed Correspondence Item 3, "Town of Ajax Councillors' Office: Support for Families and Caregivers of Children Living with Autism" in relation to increased challenges accessing supports needed for families of children with autism and special needs during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Motion

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 3 of the Correspondence Report, "Town of Ajax Councillors' Office: Support for Families and Caregivers of Children Living with Autism" be endorsed.

CARRIED

Council Members discussed Correspondence Item 4, "City of Oshawa: Poverty Reduction Approach in Oshawa".

Motion

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 4. of the Correspondence Report "City of Oshawa: Poverty Reduction Approach in Oshawa", be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Departmental Reports

Item 7.1 was addressed earlier in the meeting.

7.2 Capital Account Closing Report, December 31, 2019

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account Closings as of December 31, 2019 for information.
2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves / Reserve Funds from the December 31, 2019 Capital Account Closings, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Transfer
Capital Contingency Reserve	($398.52)	$128,622.79	$128,224.27
Building Maintenance Reserve	($47,342.98)		($47,342.98)
Roads Maintenance Reserve	($194,781.04)		($194,781.04)
General Infrastructure Reserve	($15,116.23)		($15,116.23)
Federal Gas Tax Reserve		$25,411.72	$25,411.72
2018 DC Reserve Fund		$2,049.57	$2,049.57
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	($102,800.52)	$49,280.61	($53,519.91)
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve	($89,101.14)	$68,381.02	($20,720.12)
Development Reserve	($25,429.79)	$4,054.49	($21,375.30)
Total Transfers	**($474,970.22)**	**$277,800.20**	**($197,170.02)**

CARRIED

7.3 **2020 Downtown BIA Budget and Tax Levy**

Members of Council commended the Chair and Board Members of the Downtown BIA on their work to prepare the 2020 annual budget in light of the COVID-19 emergency.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Council approve the 2020 Downtown BIA annual budget in the amount of $4,980.00.

CARRIED

7.4 **2020 BIA Levy - Pickering Village BIA**

Council Members discussed the difference in budget reductions between the Downtown BIA and Pickering Village BIA in light of the COVID-19 emergency.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Council approve the 2020 Pickering Village BIA annual budget in the amount of $30,000.00 and that the amount of $27,915.11 be raised by taxation.

CARRIED

7.5 **Development Charge Interest Policy**

Council Members asked questions regarding determination of the interest rate, interest policy best practices, and any current projects for which the policy would apply.

S. Serrao, Acting Manager of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Council and indicated the proposed rate is based on current economic state. She identified current development projects to which the policy could apply.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That the Report entitled "Development Charge Interest Policy" be received for information.

2. That the Development Charge Interest Policy, included in ATT-1, be approved.

CARRIED

7.6 Contract Award – Salt Supply

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

1. That Council award the Contract for Salt Supply to K&S Windsor Salt Ltd., in the estimated amount of $1,628,352.60 (inclusive of taxes), for a period of three years.

2. That Council authorize Staff to renew the Contract an additional two, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the Contract, in the estimated amount of $1,128,056.40 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillors provided an update regarding Durham Regional Council matters, noting that Regional Council meetings will resume in June and that Council and Committee meetings will continue through July and August. Further service reductions to Durham Region Transit were also noted.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of May 19, 2020 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Crossing at Haskell Avenue and Harwood Avenue North

Councillor Khan introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS residents have requested a pedestrian crossing at the intersection of Haskell Avenue and Harwood Avenue North;

AND WHEREAS the intersection is frequently used by patrons of the retail establishments on the east side of Harwood Avenue North;

AND WHEREAS there is no pedestrian crossing within 330 metres of the subject intersection;

AND WHEREAS the full signalization of the intersection is not planned until the 2023-2027 timeframe;

AND WHEREAS an enhanced crossing would address pedestrian concerns and provide for an interim solution;

NOW THEREFORE IT BE RESOLVED THAT:

Transportation staff evaluate the request for a crossing at the intersection of Haskell Avenue and Harwood Avenue North, and report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee by the end of June with considerations and potential options.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

9.2 Ministerial Rezoning Order to Permit a new Long-Term Care (LTC) Facility in the Town of Ajax, Region of Durham

Mayor Collier and Councillor Khan introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Council Members discussed the contents and wording of the motion, the location of the subject lands and proposed employment impact of the rezoning. Council Members asked

questions regarding next steps with the Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing, the current owner of the property, Municipal Comprehensive Review Process timelines vs. timelines for development with a rezoning order, vision for the current prestige employment zoning, potential risks for rezoning, and allocation of provincial long-term-care beds.

G. Romanowski responded to questions with clarification of the development approval timelines and authorized uses and considerations used to factor the amount of employment under prestige employment zoning.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: A. Khan

WHEREAS the Government of Ontario recognizes the urgent need to build 21st century long-term care (LTC) facilities to ensure appropriate care (maintains the best quality of life for residents as they age) is available for seniors when and where they need it; and

WHEREAS the Deputy Premier of Ontario and Minister of Health and Long-Term Care, Christine Elliott, committed (in March 2019) to adding 15,000 long-term care beds into the healthcare system in the next five years, and upgrading an additional 15,000 older long-care beds to modern design standards; and

WHEREAS these additional long-term care spaces will ease pressure on hospital infrastructure, easing "hallway healthcare" practices in hospitals and enabling nurses, doctors and other healthcare professionals to provide better, more timely health care to patients who are ill; and

WHEREAS Canadian-owned-and-operated Schlegel Villages has indicated its desire to build a new 192-bed long-term care facility, employing 230 people, at 1401 Harwood Ave. N., a project that aligns with Ontario's vision of better care for our seniors including trademark amenities, investment in people, transformational caring and integration with the larger community that both residents and employees desire; and

WHEREAS the proposed development will addresses long waitlist times and lack of specialized programming as identified by local stakeholders, including the LHIN and the Durham Ontario Health Team, and further, it allows build-out of an integrated continuum of care and Seniors Hub; and

WHEREAS the approval of this project will spark vital new investment (providing infrastructure and construction opportunities needed to rebuild the economy after COVID-19 shutdowns), including the proposed widening of Harwood North Avenue from Woodcock Avenue to Taunton Road to accommodate growth in the area; and allow Grandview Children's Centre to complete their long awaited new 130,000 square-foot headquarters for Durham Region children with special needs and families as part of this process; and

WHEREAS the planning restrictions are impeding the development vision for these lands, as the use is not currently permitted on the proposed site; and

WHEREAS consideration could be given to permit the development through the Durham Regional Municipal Comprehensive Review (MCR) currently underway, but it will not be completed until late 2022; and

WHEREAS the Ministry of Health and Long-Term Care has provided clear timelines for long-term care beds to be operational, and there is a serious risk that bed licenses may be lost; and

WHEREAS the Government of Ontario has supported similar projects, including Tollendale Village 2 in Innisfil, and Durham Christian Homes Inc. in Clarington, by enacting Ministerial Zoning Orders;

THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

That Ajax Council fully supports Schlegel Villages in its effort to build a new long-term care facility at 1401 Harwood Ave. N.; and

That, based upon the dire need to build long-term care facilities, and overall benefit to the Durham community and health care system, Ajax Council requests that the Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing enact a Ministerial Zoning Order to enable this proposal to proceed outside the MCR process; and

That this motion be circulated to the Minister of Housing and Municipal Affairs Steve Clark, Minister of Health and Long-Term Care Christine Elliott, Minister of Finance Rod Phillips and Municipality of the Region of Durham Chair John Henry.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Council Crawford, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Dies

Opposed: None

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10. By-laws

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law numbers 16-2020 and 17-2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities, including a Live Business Town Hall with Minister Rod Philips, Guyana Day Proclamation, Cyber Exchange Event, and opportunities to explore the Town supporting local businesses for re-opening through training and provision of Personal Protective Equipment suppliers.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 18-2020 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its electronic meeting held on May 19, 2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the May 19, 2020 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (9:53 p.m.)

CARRIED

Mayor

D-Clerk